

TOP 3 PAYMASTERS IN 2021-22

Percentage of job profiles securing more than 10 per cent salary increments and the top super-specialised profiles

IT & KNOWLEDGE SERVICES



32.10%
Automation engineer

HEALTHCARE & ALLIED INDUSTRIES



27.07%
R&D analyst

E-COMMERCE & TECH START-UPS



23.10%
Consultant content writer

Source: TeamLease Jobs and Salaries Primer 2022



world. With the virus lingering on in the form of milder waves, the pharma and healthcare sector plans to hire 20 per cent more in 2022 than it did in the previous year, according to Taggd's Decoding Jobs Sectoral Report 2022.

Bharat Serums and Vaccines, a home-grown vaccine maker focussed on women's health, says a bulk of its hiring usually happens in the sales function. "We need solid science orientation when it comes to the sales force. That is where we invest a lot in our training and development to build product and selling skills in addition to communication skills. We also struggle to find biotech talent, especially on the innovation side," says CHRO Nilesh Kulkarni. Margin pressure on US pharma firms is having a cascading effect on the Indian pharma sector. "They [US firms] want one person to do two jobs... and eventually a lot lesser hiring is happening in Q1 [in India], than it could have been," Taggd's Sharma says, adding that a couple of big firms have given Taggd large Q2 hiring mandates.

The pandemic has also expanded opportunities for hospitals into digital consultations and home healthcare and rehabilitation centres that require specialised manpower, beyond doctors and nurses. "In cities with a sizeable younger population and IT crowd, they don't want to go to hospitals. So, hospitals must have good digital consultation mechanisms right from booking ap-

pointments to making payments and connecting to the doctor. We need the best systems to carry on digital consultations. Otherwise, one will be left behind," says Fortis Healthcare's CHRO Ranjan Pandey. He is also confident of the hiring demand sustaining because people are more health conscious these days.

LOOKING AHEAD

What's in store beyond a year for white-collar jobs? Hard to tell, say experts, especially because of the threat of the US going into a recession, the continuing war between Russia and Ukraine, and a venture funding winter in India. Nevertheless, they see the wage premium in every sector moving towards soft skills. "We look for diverse candidates who demonstrate a growth mindset, work ethic and inclusiveness, strong communication and problem-solving skills, as well as high learning agility," says Cognizant's Weitzman. As career spans increase and technology plays a starring role, continuous learning and digital literacy are becoming crucial, say experts. TeamLease's Sabharwal puts it best. "Machines will never be able to compete with humans at being human... So, learning how to learn is more important than knowledge." That's a lesson one must learn. **BT**

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